BYSSSUS

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Extracted Text

BYSSSUS, in antiquity, that fine Egyptian then whirco- of the tunes of the jewith prints we make.

Pulio Rey, that the byllas is the clearelt and moft beautiful, the whistel, froongel, and molt glolly fore of linesy that it is not made of any thing mortal, that is softy, of wool, or the skin of way animal, but that it comes out of the earth, and becomes always white, and more thinning, when it is waffed as it fluid he.

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Button attempted to find out a north-weſt paſſage to the Eaſt Indies. It lies between 80° and 100° W. long. and between 60° and 66° N. lat.

BUTTRESS, a kind of butment built archwiſe, or a maſs of ſtone or brick, ſerving to prop or ſupport the ſides of a building, wall, &c. on the outſide, where it is either very high, or has any conſiderable load to ſuſtain on the other ſide, as a bank of earth, &c.

Buttreſſes are uſed againſt the angles of ſteeples and other buildings of ſtone, &c. on the outſide, and along the walls of ſuch buildings as have great and heavy roofs, which would be ſubject to thruſt the walls out, unleſs very thick, if no buttreſſes were placed againſt them. They are alſo placed for a ſupport and butment againſt the feet of ſome arches, that are turned acroſs great halls in old palaces, abbeys, &c.

BUTZAW, a town of Lower Saxony, in Germany; it ſtands upon the river Varnow, on the road from Schwerin to Roſtock.

BUXTON, a place in the peak of Derbyſhire, celebrated for medicinal waters; the hotteſt in England, next to Bath.

BUXTON-*wells*. The ſtrata of earth and minerals, in the parts adjacent to Buxton, are peat-moſs, blue clay, iron, and coal, mixed with ſulphur and brazil.

The warm waters there, at preſent, are the bath, which takes in ſeveral warm ſprings; St Ann's well, a hot and cold ſpring riſing up into the ſame receptacle; and Bingham-well.

Theſe waters greatly promote digeſtion, unleſs they are drunk too long, in which caſe they relax the ſtomach, and retard digeſtion; they are well adapted to obſtructions of every kind, whence they produce ſurpriſing effects in gouty, rheumatic, athritic, and ſcorbutic pains. As this water is warm, highly impregnated with a mineral ſteam, vapour, or ſpirit, it is ſignally beneficial to cramps, convulſions, dry aſthmas, the bilious colic, ſtiffneſs, &c.

They adviſe both drinking and bathing in the uſe of theſe waters; only the laſt is of bad conſequence in the gout, inward inflammations, fevers, dyſentery, large inward tumours, or in an outward preſſure of the body.

BUXUS, in botany, a genus of the monœcia tetrandria claſs. The calix of the male conſiſts of three leaves; and the corolla has two petals: The calix of the female has four leaves; the petals are three; it has three ſtyli; and the capſule has three cells containing two ſeeds. There is but one ſpecies, *viz.* the ſempervirens, or box-tree, a native of Britain. A decoction of the leaves and wood has been recommended as a powerful ſudorific; but is not now uſed by practitioners. The wood is of a hard cloſe texture, and is greatly uſed by mechanics for tools of various kinds.

BUYS, a town of Dauphine, in France, ſituated on the confines of Provence; E. long. 5° 20′, and N. lat. 44° 25′.

BUZZARD, in ornithology, the Engliſh name of ſeveral ſpecies of the hawk kind. See FALCO.

BYGHOF, or BYGOW, a city of Lithuania in Poland, ſituated on the river Nieper; E. long. 30°, and N. lat. 53°.

BY-LAWS, or BYE-LAWS, private and peculiar laws for the good government of a city, court, or other community, made by the general conſent of the members.

All by-laws are to be reaſonable, and for the common benefit, not private advantage of any particular perſons, and muſt be agreeable to the public laws in being.

BYRLAW, or BYRLAW *laws*, in Scotland, are made and determined by neighbours, elected by common conſent in byrlaw courts. The men choſen as judges, are called byrlaw or burlaw men, and take cognizance of complaints between neighbour and neighbour.

BYRRHUS, in zoology, an order of inſects belonging to the order of coleoptera. The feelers are clavated, pretty ſolid, and a little compreſſed. There are five ſpecies, all of which are to be found on particular plants, and principally diſtinguiſhed from each other by the colour and figure of the elytra or cruſtaceous wing-caſes.

BYSSUS, in botany, a genus of moſſes belonging to the cryptogamia algæ. The character is taken from this circumſtance, that they are covered with a ſimple capillary filament or down, reſembling ſoft duſt. The ſpecies are 15, all natives of Britain.

BYSSUS, in antiquity, that fine Egyptian linen whereof the tunics of the Jewiſh prieſts were made.

Philo ſays, that the byſſus is the cleareſt and moſt beautiful, the whiteſt, ſtrongeſt, and moſt gloſſy ſort of linen; that it is not made of any thing mortal, that is to ſay, of wool, or the ſkin of any animal, but that it comes out of the earth, and becomes always whiter, and more ſhining, when it is waſhed as it ſhould be.

BYZANT. See BEZANT.

BYZANTIUM, the ancient name of Conſtantinople. See CONSTANTINOPLE.

BZO, a town of Africa, in the kingdom of Morocco.

END OF THE FIRST VOLUME.

Figure 1: *
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